

Michael de la Morena

Engineering Manager • Cloud Infrastructure & Platform Engineering

Engineering leader specializing in cloud platform architecture, Kubernetes governance, and large-scale infrastructure modernization. Led multi-cluster enterprise environments, reduced cloud spend by 62%, and accelerated service onboarding through automation and standardized provisioning. Experienced in aligning platform engineering with business outcomes, strengthening enterprise security posture and governance controls, and enabling developer velocity at scale. Hands-on across AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, Harness, and Crossplane, while actively integrating LLM-assisted engineering workflows, prompt engineering techniques, and agent-based automation to enhance development, infrastructure operations, and troubleshooting workflows.

Core Competencies

Engineering Leadership • Cloud Infrastructure • Platform Engineering • Kubernetes & Containerization • CI/CD Pipeline Development • Developer Enablement • Observability & Incident Response • Cloud Security & Compliance • Scalability & Cost Optimization • AI-Assisted Development

Professional Experience

Sr. Engineer (SRE)

Walt Disney World (TEKSystems) | Gainesville, FL | 2025–Present

Senior platform engineer focused on automation, governance, and developer enablement across a large multi-cluster Kubernetes environment. Drive platform standardization, supply chain security, and self-service infrastructure workflows while coordinating cross-functional engineering efforts and third-party vendors.

- Built reusable Harness onboarding templates and a self-service provisioning workflow using Score.dev and Crossplane to automate object storage, database, and caching services. Replaced manual Terraform deployments with standardized templates, reducing change management friction and enabling same-day service onboarding.
- Built secure Harness pipelines to compile and publish Crossplane providers to AWS ECR, strengthening infrastructure supply chain controls and improving provisioning reliability.
- Conducted an in-depth architectural and operational review of Kubernetes cluster deployment templates across AWS and GCP, executing template-driven changes across a fleet of 40+ clusters to validate scalability, reliability, and enterprise readiness for development and production environments.
- Authored platform runbooks and technical documentation covering Kubernetes, Argo CD, Helm, and Crossplane, reducing onboarding ramp time by 50% and improving operational continuity.
- Implemented AI-assisted engineering workflows using Claude Code with custom Skills, Agents, and MCP integrations (Git, Kubernetes) to improve development efficiency and enable LLM-driven infrastructure inspection and diagnostics.
- Coordinated delivery across internal teams and external vendors, aligning platform roadmap priorities with engineering execution.

Staff Engineer

Fracture | Gainesville, FL | 2023–2025

Led modernization of cloud infrastructure, cost optimization, and developer workflows while mentoring peers on cloud architecture best practices.

- Directed migration to AWS EKS with Transit Gateway automation, improving scalability and network reliability.
- Reduced AWS spend by 62% (\$527K cumulative savings) through query optimization, backend refactoring, and rightsizing, enabling migration to lower-tier hardware without sacrificing performance.
- Guided a Postgres 10→14 upgrade under tight timelines, improving database stability and performance.
- Implemented Shopify EventBridge integration for event-driven architecture, streamlining internal service communication.
- Transitioned observability from Splunk + RUM to a Kubernetes-native stack (EFK + Prometheus/Grafana) with Helm-driven automation, reducing costs and improving insights.
- Developed LLM-assisted engineering workflows using Claude and ChatGPT to analyze legacy codebases, guide refactoring strategies, and enforce coding standards, reducing developer effort by 40–60% while improving maintainability across critical backend systems.
- Experimented with agent-based AI workflows integrating external tools and system context to assist with code generation, architecture analysis, and development tasks, evaluating the practical role of LLMs in existing software engineering workflows.

Engineering Manager

Fracture | Gainesville, FL | 2022–2023

Provided leadership across infrastructure, content platforms, and monitoring. Mentored engineers and facilitated cross-team decision-making.

- Directed migration to Shopify and Kubernetes, improving scalability and performance.
- Oversaw transition from WordPress to Contentful, streamlining publishing workflows and reducing time-to-publish.
- Championed database migration and observability improvements (Splunk + RUM), enhancing system stability and visibility.
- Led internal tech talks, office hours, and engineering discussions to mentor developers, answer technical questions, with topics on Platform Engineering, Site Reliability, and Cloud Architecture.

Software Developer 4

Fracture | Gainesville, FL | 2020–2022

Acted as a technical mentor while driving automation and platform tooling to support DevOps maturity.

- Designed secure Kubernetes deployment automation, reducing lead times and improving reliability.
- Championed Helm and CI/CD pipeline adoption, standardizing deployments across teams.

Cloud Design Engineer

TEKsystems (Disney Parks) | Orlando, FL | 2019–2020

- Designed scalable reference architectures and led technical debt reduction initiatives.

- Improved CI/CD architecture supporting thousands of pipelines and mitigated base image supply chain risks.
- Built Python tooling to audit AWS instances across accounts, and delivered Elasticsearch provisioning + incident response training for engineers.

Systems Architect / Cloud Systems Engineer

Shadow Health | Gainesville, FL | 2017–2019

Led migration to Kubernetes, replacing legacy production systems serving 100,000 monthly users.

- Designed modular CI/CD pipelines (Jenkins, Helm) with canary/blue-green deployments.
- Built disaster recovery automation, achieving 15-minute recovery times.
- Directed Kubernetes gameday scenarios and a 5-week training program, enabling engineers to independently migrate applications.
- Implemented RBAC and HashiCorp Vault for secure secrets management; automated performance/load testing pipelines.

Developer

Mobile Nations / Smartphone Experts | Key Biscayne, FL | 2010–2017

Delivered SaaS integrations, e-commerce enhancements, and internal tooling across PHP, Python, and Node.js.

- Built a mass email marketing system generating \$15K/month in new revenue.
- Deployed Sphinx search engine across properties, enabling unified site-wide search.
- Improved forum and e-commerce operations with custom Node.js tools and PHP cart refactoring.

Additional Experience

- Software Developer | Market Leverage
- Programmer I | Solution: Unitech
- Help Desk Technician | Gainsco Auto Insurance
- Web Developer | Miami-Dade College

Technical Proficiencies

- AI/Automation: ChatGPT, Claude, MCP Integrations
- Cloud & Containers: AWS (EKS, EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda, CloudFormation), Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, Argo CD, Crossplane
- CI/CD & Platform: Harness, Jenkins, GitOps, Infrastructure as Code
- Observability & Security: EFK, Prometheus, Grafana, Splunk, RUM, HashiCorp Vault/Consul, Secrets Management, Incident Response
- Languages & Databases: Python, JavaScript, Node.js, PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL

Education

B.S., Computer Information Systems (Enterprise Computing)
DeVry University, Miramar, FL | Summa Cum Laude, 4.0 GPA